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Emiproc: A Python package for emission inventory processing

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Software

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Summary

Emission inventories are created by countries and regions to assess and address air quality and climate change targets. An emission inventory is a spatial dataset that reports the yearly amount of pollutants released into the atmosphere, often broken down by specific source sectors or individual sources. Atmospheric modellers use such inventories to simulate the transport of emitted species in order to compute their distribution and assess their potential impact on the environment. The simulations are often compared with measurements to verify if the declared emissions and their trends are consistent with the observed changes in the atmosphere, thereby enhancing confidence in the inventories.

Figure 1 presents an example of a gridded inventory.

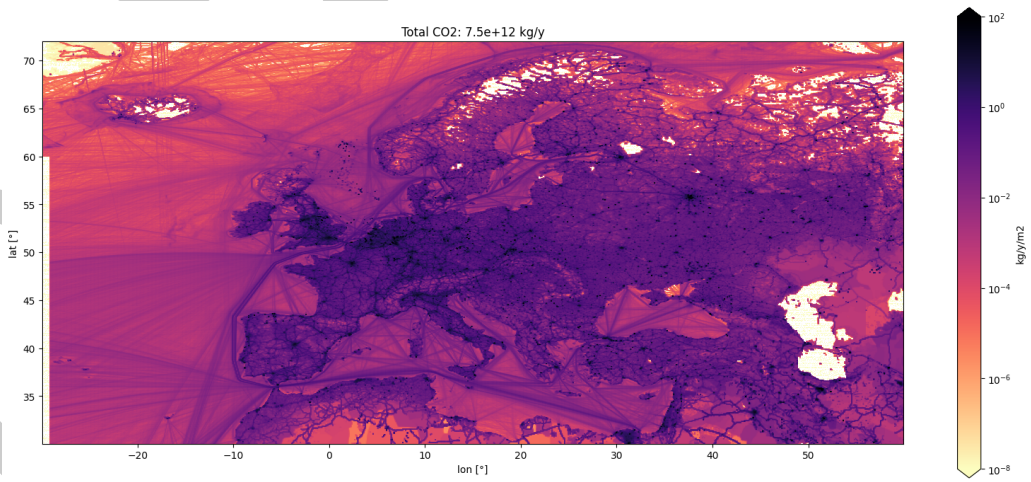

Figure 1: CO2 emissions of the year 2015 from the inventory produced by TNO .

Inventories are created in multiple different formats and resolutions, which makes it difficult to compare and use them in atmospheric transport models. For example, TNO (Dutch Organization for Applied Scientific Research) provides inventories which contains both, area emissions on a regular grid and point sources at their exact locations. Other inventories, such as one from the city of Zurich, are provided as vector data with various shapes (points, lines, polygons) depending on the category of the source. Atmospheric models require emission inventories to be in a specific file format. For example ICON-ART (Schröter et al., 2018) requires emissions on a semi-structured triangular grid and temporal profiles to scale the

emissions with hourly, daily and monthly variability.

Statement of need

emiproc is a Python package that provides tools for processing emission inventories, harmonizing datasets, and preparing such data as inputs for atmospheric transport models. Designed to be flexible and extendable, emiproc allows users to easily add custom functionality, read new inventories or export data to other formats.

When modellers design their simulations, they are often interested in modifying the inventories. For example, they could do the following: scale emissions based on future scenarios, aggregate emissions by sector or pollutant to simplify their simulations or combine multiple inventories to represent different sources such as anthropogenic and natural emissions. emiproc provides this functionality and has already been successfully applied for different use cases:

- Steiner et al. (2024) produced emission files for ICON-ART-OEM based on the EDGARv6 inventory (Monforti Ferrario et al., 2021) (Emissions Database for Global Atmospheric Research).
- Dönmez & Brunner (2024) conducted urban climate simulation using emissions produced with emiproc for cities of Zurich and Basel.
- Ponomarev & Brunner (2024) used emiproc to nest the Zurich city inventory inside the Swiss national inventory and to further nest the Swiss inventory inside the European TNO inventory.

emiproc shares some of its functionality with another Python tool, HERMESv3 (Guevara et al., 2019), which is also designed to process emission data and generate input files for atmospheric transport models.
Compared to HERMESv3, which relies on specific configuration files, emiproc is more flexible, extensible and practical as it can be integrated in existing Python-based workflows.

History

An earlier version of emiproc was already published by Jähn et al. (2020), but it was limited to specific models and inventories. Starting in 2022 emiproc has been refactored to satisfy the requirements of high flexibility and modularity. This included major changes to code structure, the addition of new capabilities, a major performance increase for the task of spatial regridding, a comprehensive documentation and the addition of test examples.

Since then the package is regularly updated with new features and bug fixes.

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Design

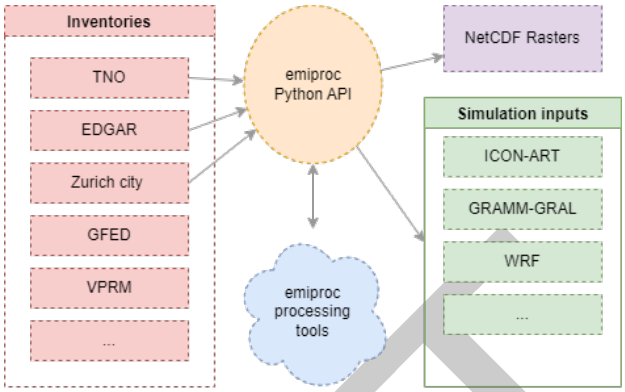

Figure 2: Design of emiproc.

The API of `emiproc` leverages the advantages of object-oriented programming. The main class is `Inventory`. It provides a common data structure to represent and harmonize all the different emission inventories. The `Grid` object represent the spatial distribution of the emission. It is flexible enough to implement all kinds of grids, from regular latitude-longitude grids to the icosahedral grid from the ICON Model (ICON partnership et al., 2024). Finally `TemporalProfile` and `VerticalProfile` are used for the distribution of emissions in time and height.

Thanks to the harmonization of the data, functions for additional data processing can easily be applied to the different inventories once loaded into `emiproc`. These functions are listed in the API documentation . Examples of operations on inventory data are among others:

- remapping to different model grids
- aggregating emissions by sector or pollutant
- crop an inventory over a specific area

`emiproc` also allows for generation of additional emission sectors not always present in the inventories. For example, the vegetation emissions can be modelled through VPRM (Vegetation Photosynthesis and Respiration Model) (Mahadevan et al., 2008).

The export of inventories for various atmospheric models is done through custom functions that produce all emission input files required by the model.

For data vizualisation `emiproc` provides custom functions based on `matplotlib` (Hunter, 2007). Figure 1 was created using such a function.

`emiproc` is built on top of `geopandas` (Jordahl et al., 2020), which allows storing the geometries of the emission maps and offers many functionalities related to geometric operations. Within `emiproc`, the emission data of the inventory is stored as a `geopandas.GeoDataFrame`.

Availability

The package is available on GitHub and the documentation is available on readthedocs.

Tutorials are available to guide new users. A good first start is the Edgar processing tutorial which shows how `emiproc` can be used to load, process and export a freely available inventory.

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